A REALITY CHECK ON AI

Is Artificial Intelligence (AI) a boon or bane, will it take away my job, or will it augment my job? These are the basic questions that set the tone for any discussion on artificial intelligence (AI), especially with the technology wave being unleashed by Generative AI, which promises to democratise creativity by bringing expertise to people's fingertips. Speaking at the India Today Conclave, Vyshak Venugopalan, director, Solution Consulting, Adobe India, pointed to how Generative AI models can today create real-time images with just a text prompt, thereby amplifying production cycles. According to Samik Roy, executive director, India & South Asia, Microsoft, AI-based technology is helping organisations make decisions across a wide range of areas—from calculating demand forecasts and production targets to processing claim approvals or in fraud analytics. Giving an example, he said, ChatGPT took three months to reach a hundred million users worldwide, whereas the Internet took seven years to reach that scale and mobile phones took 16 years. "It's telling you how fast people are using it because they see value in it."

Critical to AI technology, however, are the built-in guardrails for bias, privacy and security. A core element in ethical or responsible AI are the data sets on which models are trained. "It's absolutely important to see through what you are feeding the AI," said Vyshak. Deepfakes (digitally manipulated images and videos), he added, is the other big challenge, given how there will always be bad actors wielding AI technology. What's needed is an approach akin to the "nutrition label" we currently have on packaged food products. The need for "responsible guardrails" assumes even more importance with talks of artificial general intelligence—"which supersedes human intelligence". The bottom line, according to Roy, is "how it is used". "As you discover new things, there'll be new guardrails, there will be new rules," he said.

As for the AI impact on jobs, "When computer and Internet came, people said it will take away all jobs... Today, India is the womb of the IT industry of the world," Roy said. Is it possible to not be a part of the change? "We all have to dip our toes in, to benefit as individuals, as organisations," said Vyshak. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Generative AI will help people and organisations work faster, speed up production cycles**
- **Six principles core to ethical or responsible AI are accountability, inclusion, fairness, scalability, privacy and security**
- **Accountability and responsibility come from training the AI model on the right set of data**



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